Benchmark reference answer

Question	Are asylum seekers allowed to claim benefits?
Essential The very minimum an answer needs to include. Comprises: ● Any accurate answer to what the user asked for. ● What the user needs to know in order to avoid being misled.	- No, people who are claiming asylum cannot claim or access mainstream welfare benefits like Universal Credit from the government. - People who have an active asylum case and are considered destitute (they are homeless or do not have enough money to buy food) can apply for specific asylum support from the government - somewhere to live, a cash allowance, or both.
Good answer If the bare essentials aren't enough to meet an "average" user's needs. Comprises: ● Information that further answers the user's question, but that goes beyond what is strictly "essential" *This section is **optional** and is unnecessary for basic questions.*	- The cash support for asylum seekers is (as of September 2026) £9.95 per person per week if the asylum seeker's accommodation provides meals, and £49.18 per person per week if not. (Though pregnant women and mothers of children aged three or under receive slightly more each week) - This support is also available during asylum appeals. - Asylum seekers cannot access social housing - If an asylum claim is accepted and someone is granted refugee status, they become eligible to apply for Universal Credit and social housing
Background Core facts relevant to the question — use as a reference guide for annotators.	- Asylum support - housing - - By law, the Home Office is responsible for housing asylum seekers who don't have anywhere to live (Section 95, 1999 Immigration and Asylum Act - essential living needs) - Asylum support - cash allowance - Subsistence support under Section 95 of Immigration and Asylum Act - If in accommodation such as a hotel that provides meals, the support is currently (September 2026) £9.95 a week for each person in the household - If meals are not provided, it's £49.18 a week for each person in the household - Pregnant women receive an additional £5.25 a week - Mothers with a baby under 1 year old receive an additional £9.50 a week - Mothers with a child aged 1 to 3 receive an additional £5.25 a week - Mothers can also apply for a one-off maternity grant of £300 if a baby is due in 11 weeks or less, or if the baby is under 6 months old - The money is loaded onto a prepaid debit card (ASPEN) card each week - Other support, if eligible for asylum support: - Children must attend state schools if they are aged 5 to 17, and may be eligible for free school meals - Healthcare - free prescriptions, free dental care, free eyesight tests, help paying for glasses, access to NHS care - Section 96 support is considered on an individual basis, and provides additional support for essential needs due to specific circumstances, such as someone who needs to make a high

	number of essential journeys, or someone who needs a temporary increase in support due to temporary health issues, like recovery from an operation, or to replace items lost in something like a fire. Home Office guidance says it will not meet needs that can be covered elsewhere, such as by local authorities Other situations - Asylum seekers who don't receive asylum support may still get free prescriptions in England due to other rules - e.g. they may be pregnant or eligible due to their age. Prescriptions are free for everyone in Scotland and Northern Ireland, and free in Wales for those registered with a GP - Asylum seekers whose claims have been rejected can apply for Section 4 or short term support, if they are homeless, don't have money to buy food and if there's a good reason they can't yet leave the UK (though they won't be given the payment card without housing) - Asylum seekers are generally not permitted to work - Asylum support usually ends 42 days (6 weeks) after someone is granted refugee status